

Primary health care (PHC)

- Primary health care (PHC) provides essential nutrition services including growth monitoring, breastfeeding support, micronutrient supplementation (vitamin A, iron), and treatment of malnutrition, crucial for achieving universal health coverage.
- It serves as the primary, community-level, preventive, and curative, approach to reducing malnutrition, targeting high-risk populations in rural and urban areas.

- **Key Aspects of Nutrition Coverage in PHC**
- Preventive Services: Nutritional counselling, promotion of breastfeeding, and advice on healthy diets.
- Curative Services: Treatment of acute malnutrition, including wasting and stunting.
- Supplementary Nutrition: Administration of micronutrient supplements (vitamin A, zinc, iron, folic acid).
- Target Population: Focus on pregnant women, lactating mothers, and children under five.



- Integration: Nutrition is increasingly integrated into maternal and child health programs (e.g., in India, National Health Mission).
- Effectiveness: Integrated nutrition interventions can reduce stunting by 20% and severe wasting by 61% when covering 90% of the population.